

is to wait for Windows to download the required files. The download is approximately 4 GB, so ensure you have enough space and bandwidth for the download. After the download is complete, simply follow all the onscreen prompts and your computer should restart, following which Windows will begin installation. Make sure you click “Next” when required, and setup Windows as per your requirements once it boots into the now upgraded OS.

So which of these options is best for me?

Option (a) is ideal if you do not want to be bothered with making any sort of backup. You can also roll back to your original operating system if you’re not happy with the Windows 10 experience. Unfortunately, the convenience of this method does entail a few drawbacks. There’s always the possibility of some compatibility issue rearing its ugly head. Maybe the drivers need to be reinstalled or maybe some corrupt registry entries have broken other programs.

If you want to backup your personal files including photos and videos and do not mind having to reconfigure Windows while also reinstalling programs, then option (b) is the way to go. For those who want to install Windows with a clean slate and with factory settings, Option (c) will help you with just that. It will wipe your system partition clean so you will lose all files and programs stored on it. Just ensure you have all your important files backed up.

Nice. I now have Windows installed. What was the point of that second option?

Performing a clean install of Windows 10

Well, “Create installation media for another PC” in essence allows you to make a bootable disk (DVD or USB stick) which you can use to perform a clean installation of Windows. Most experienced Windows users will tell you that a clean install of Windows (or any operating system) is the best way to purge your system of any and all software-related issues—from broken applications to malware injections. Upgrading the operating system provides a perfect opportunity for a clean install, and it is obvious many users will want to take advantage of installing their new OS on a blank system.

****IMPORTANT:** Note that Microsoft has stated in its support forums (<http://digit.in/1Jo5fjB>) that you must use the “Upgrade this PC now” option if you are upgrading from Windows 7/8/8.1. This is the only way to get your copy of Windows 10 activated. The only way you can use a product key to activate